Linux Basic Commands Cheat Sheet

A quick reference for everyday Linux terminal use

File & Directory Navigation

`pwd`	print working directory
`ls`	list files
`ls -la`	list all files (including hidden) with details
`cd <dir>`	change directory
`cd ..`	go up one directory
`cd ~`	go to home directory
`tree`	show directory structure (may need install)

File & Directory Management

`mkdir <dir>`	create directory
`mkdir -p a/b/c`	create nested directories
`touch <file>`	create empty file
`cp <src> <dest>`	copy file
`cp -r <src> <dest>`	copy directory recursively
`mv <src> <dest>`	move/rename file
`rm <file>`	delete file
`rm -r <dir>`	delete directory recursively
`rm -rf <dir>`	force delete (use carefully!)

Viewing & Editing Files

`cat <file>`	print file content
`less <file>`	view file page by page
`head <file>`	first 10 lines
`tail <file>`	last 10 lines
`tail -f <file>`	follow file live (great for logs)
`nano <file>`	simple terminal editor

`vim <file>`	advanced terminal editor

Searching

`grep "text" <file>`	search text in a file
`grep -r "text" <dir>`	search recursively
`find <dir> -name "*.txt"`	find files by name
`locate <filename>`	fast file search (needs updatedb)
`which <command>`	show path of a command

Permissions & Ownership

`chmod +x <file>`	make file executable
`chmod 755 <file>`	set specific permissions
`chown user:group <file>`	change file owner/group
`sudo <command>`	run command as superuser

Process Management

`ps aux`	list running processes
`top`	live process monitor
`htop`	better live monitor (if installed)
`kill <pid>`	kill a process
`kill -9 <pid>`	force kill
`jobs`	list background jobs
`bg / fg`	background/foreground a job

Disk & System Info

`df -h`	disk space usage
`du -sh <dir>`	size of a directory
`free -h`	memory usage
`uname -a`	system info
`uptime`	system uptime

`whoami`	current user

Networking

`ping <host>`	check connectivity
`curl <url>`	fetch a URL
`wget <url>`	download a file
`ifconfig / ip a`	show network interfaces
`netstat -tulnp`	show open ports
`ssh user@host`	connect to remote server
`scp <file> user@host:path`	copy file over SSH

Package Management (Debian/Ubuntu)

`sudo apt update`	update package list
`sudo apt upgrade`	upgrade packages
`sudo apt install <pkg>`	install a package
`sudo apt remove <pkg>`	remove a package

Compression

`tar -cvf archive.tar <dir>`	create tar archive
`tar -xvf archive.tar`	extract tar archive
`tar -czvf archive.tar.gz <dir>`	create gzip-compressed archive
`tar -xzvf archive.tar.gz`	extract gzip archive
`zip -r archive.zip <dir>`	create zip
`unzip archive.zip`	extract zip

Misc Useful

`history`	show command history
`clear`	clear terminal
`echo "text"`	print text
`man <command>`	manual/help for a command

`alias ll='ls -la'`	create a shortcut command
`exit`	close terminal/session